

Chapter 53: Same or Different

Yan Lin's mother followed Yan Lin's gaze and saw Feng Yue standing at the door, so she said to Yan Lin: "Look, isn't that Xiao Yue? How can you say she's dead? You just woke up and you're talking nonsense - it's really unlucky!"

As she spoke, Yan Lin's mother even glared at Yan Lin reproachfully.

But Feng Yue, standing at the door, couldn't hear a single word. Her mind was now echoing with all the words Yan Lin had spoken.

She herself could come back to life after death, so why couldn't Yan Lin? Feng Yue was certain that she had truly died back then, but according to that book, Yan Lin had been living well the whole time, and even ended up living happily with that Chu An'an.

Could something unexpected have happened, causing Yan Lin to die accidentally?

Also, when she first arrived here, this body had also fainted due to the first onset of brain cancer.

Yan Lin had also hit her head and fainted last night.

This point matched up. So, was it true? Was Yan Lin really the same as her?

While Feng Yue was frantically brainstorming, Yan Lin, lying on the hospital bed, stared blankly at Feng Yue standing at the door - the person who had left her for more than three years.

"Ah Yue..." Yan Lin's voice was hoarse, even carrying a hint of sobbing.

"Child, why are you crying!" Yan Lin's mother looked at the tears rolling down from Yan Lin's eyes in disbelief.

Yan Lin had been mature since childhood. Since they could remember, they had never seen Yan Lin cry, as if nothing could stir waves in her heart.

But now, crystal clear tears were rolling from Yan Lin's eyes.

Hearing Yan Lin's mother's words, Yan Lin realized she was crying. She felt as if her heart was being tightly grasped by someone, and her nose felt sour. She reached up to touch her cheek and indeed felt moisture.

So she really missed Feng Yue this much.

Feng Yue's feet seemed glued to the floor, unable to move a step. She didn't know how to face this new "Yan Lin," couldn't even say a word.

Based on those few sentences, this Yan Lin had experienced her death, so she must know what happened after her death.

The memories about her previous life that had been sealed in Feng Yue's mind gradually awakened. She hadn't seen Yan Lin one last time; she had left that world with regret, and she could still clearly remember her parents' final anguished cries.

Her life had ended early, but the person before her knew what happened after her death.

Feng Yue's hands hanging at her sides clenched tightly into fists, even trembling slightly from excessive force.

No one in this world could gracefully face the situation of relatives who were still alive after their own death.

She feared everyone would forget her, feared that the traces of her having lived would just vanish into thin air, feared she would become an outsider, losing all those who had once loved her.

She dared not ask, but she had to ask.

This was an opportunity - a chance that could let her completely abandon the past and live well in the present.

She shouldn't be like a cold, observing outsider, watching everyone in this world. They were alive and real, not just passersby whose entire lives were summed up in a few words in that book.

The two young people clearly had much to say, and Yan Lin's mother wasn't someone without awareness, so she actively suggested: "You two talk first. I'll go see Ah Lin's attending physician."

As she spoke, Yan Lin's mother prepared to leave the ward, but when she walked to Feng Yue's side, she patted her shoulder. "Xiao Yue, if anything happens, just press the bell. The doctor will come quickly."

Feng Yue swallowed and nodded.

After Yan Lin's mother left, the ward became quiet. But Feng Yue still stood there without moving a step, while Yan Lin on the hospital bed continued to stare at her blankly, her eyes showing indescribable attachment and longing.

Feng Yue knew she had to take this step, and knew that today she might lay everything out with Yan Lin and explain everything clearly.

Rebirth was her biggest secret, something she had never told anyone.

And the current Yan Lin might be the only person in this world who had exactly the same experience as her.

Feng Yue took a deep breath, slightly moved her right foot forward one step, her gaze directly locked onto Yan Lin's eyes, never avoiding or hesitating: "I did indeed die."

Yan Lin's heart pounded wildly, her pupils contracted slightly, and her right hand resting on the blanket clenched tightly.

"May 4th, 2021, St. Margaret Hospital in Berlin, Germany. The specific time should have been around 9 AM. I died due to deteriorating condition." Feng Yue's expression was cold, showing no emotion. "You didn't see me one last time."

Yan Lin's throat seemed blocked. Everything Feng Yue said was correct, and these words shocked her to the core.

"You should have many questions now. I can tell you the current date: November 9th, 2020. You're probably like me - you've come back once. We've both returned to the past."

This absurd and ridiculous information was dumped in front of Yan Lin by Feng Yue. Whether Yan Lin could accept it was completely outside Feng Yue's consideration. She just wanted to know what she wanted to know.

"I'm telling you this not because I want anything. I just hope you can tell me - how were my parents after I died?"

Yan Lin stared at Feng Yue speechlessly.

"Did they... live well?" Feng Yue's voice was very soft, as if she was murmuring to herself.

Yan Lin didn't know how to answer her for a moment. This series of events was too incredible for Yan Lin, but beneath this incredibility, Yan Lin felt fortunate.

She was silent for a long time, thinking about how to begin, because after Feng Yue's death, the two elders of the Feng family hadn't lived very well.

Losing a daughter in middle age, white-haired parents burying their black-haired child¹ - anyone who encountered such a thing couldn't possibly have an easy time.

"Dad started transferring the company's main business overseas after you died. Mom's mental condition wasn't very good, so Dad had to take her to settle abroad." Yan Lin lowered her eyes. "I would occasionally go abroad to stay with them for a few days. Over time, Mom's condition improved quite a bit."

"It's just that... I, they... still miss you very much."

Feng Yue listened quietly, so quietly it was almost excessive.

Yan Lin looked up at her and discovered that Feng Yue's face was already covered with tears. Her heart tightened, and she threw off the blanket wanting to get out of bed, but this movement made her realize that her neck injury was more serious than she had imagined. Accidentally pulling at the wound, Yan Lin couldn't help but cry out in pain.

Hearing her voice, Feng Yue finally came back to her senses. She wiped her tears and said with a sob: "Thank you."

"It's nothing. Then... how are they now?" Yan Lin asked.

"They're very well now."

"What about you?"

Feng Yue didn't understand what she meant by this.

"Your illness..." Yan Lin became anxious thinking about this. "I'll go to Germany with you, right now to see Dr. Wendel². He can definitely save you!"

As she spoke, Yan Lin wanted to find her phone to have someone contact that Dr. Wendel.

Feng Yue interrupted her actions: "My illness is fine. It's already under control."

Yan Lin awkwardly stopped what she was doing. Right, since Feng Yue said she was also reborn, then the first thing she would do after rebirth would definitely be to see a doctor to save her life.

Feng Yue added: "I think there's one more thing I need to tell you. Two months ago, we went through divorce procedures."

Now Yan Lin was truly completely stunned.

Di... divorce?!

Yan Lin didn't know how things could turn out this way. Both she and Feng Yue had been reborn to the past, so why would they divorce? Didn't Feng Yue like her? Hadn't she liked her for a very, very long time?

Seeing Yan Lin's completely bewildered expression, Feng Yue actually felt somewhat pleased. She rarely got to see such an expression on Yan Lin's face - the other person always maintained a calm and composed appearance in front of her.

Indeed, human nature's flaws were hard to eliminate. Watching the high and mighty flower³ fall from her pedestal into the mundane world full of earthly concerns - this satisfaction was incomparable to anything.

Feng Yue didn't explain much more about their relationship. She now wanted to know what conditions Yan Lin had for being reborn, whether they were the same as hers. She even wanted to use Yan Lin to verify whether the predetermined facts in that novel could actually be changed.

"After I died, I directly awakened here. What about you? Did you also die?" Feng Yue concealed the fact that she had seen that book.

Yan Lin was still immersed in the shock that she had already divorced Feng Yue. Hearing Feng Yue's question, she could only think stiffly.

Did I die? Yan Lin asked herself in her heart. It seemed like I died? No, it seemed like I didn't die.

But if she hadn't died, how did she get here? What was she doing before opening her eyes here?

Yan Lin felt her mind was too chaotic. Things that she had clearly remembered not long ago seemed covered by a thin veil in her mind - unclear and inaudible.

"I... didn't die." Yan Lin felt her vision starting to sway, the aftereffects of the concussion making her feel dizzy.

"I forgot what I was doing before coming here, but I'm certain I didn't die."

Hearing this, Feng Yue pondered for a moment, then continued asking: "Then your sudden disappearance must have made your wife very panicked, right?"

"Who? Wife?" Yan Lin frowned tightly. She didn't know why Feng Yue would ask her this.

Besides Feng Yue, she didn't have any wife. Until she woke up here, she could be certain that the label attached to her regarding marital status was the glaring word "widowed."

"Ah, I was just guessing randomly. After all, from what you just said, I've probably been dead for several years. I thought you might have entered another marriage." Feng Yue smiled apologetically, as if this really was just an unimportant guess of hers.

But Yan Lin didn't think so. She looked seriously at Feng Yue not far away and said word by word: "I didn't marry anyone else. My legal partner has always been only you. Whether it's three years or longer, it will always be only you..."

Yan Lin's last sentence suddenly became much softer, but Feng Yue still heard it clearly.

"Three years..." If Feng Yue remembered correctly, according to the book, Yan Lin and Chu An'an's first meeting was in the fourth year after her death.

Footnotes:

¹ **White-haired parents burying their black-haired child (白发人送黑发人)** - A Chinese idiom describing the tragedy of parents outliving their children, considered one of life's greatest sorrows

² **Dr. Wendel** - Presumably a specialist doctor in Germany who had been treating Feng Yue's condition in the previous timeline

³ **High and mighty flower (高岭之花)** - A Japanese-derived term meaning someone who seems perfect and unattainable, like a flower blooming on a high peak